

IAS MAINS 2020

VALUE ADDITION

GS - I

GS - II

GS - III

GS - IV

12 QUESTIONS WITH MODEL ANSWERS

MODULE - 14

GS – I ... INDIAN SOCIETY

- 28 Worker to population ratio among women reduced drastically in rural areas in comparison to urban areas. Is it due to faster decline in work opportunities in rural India for women? Argue. How far do the present Government policies facilitate protecting the livelihoods of rural women? (250 Words)
- 29 “More than a third of India’s population lives in urban areas and they produce more than 3/5th of the country’s GDP, but the governance structures in urban areas / semi-urban areas are archaic and chaotic”. Do you agree? Give valid arguments. Suggest the way forward for orderly growth of urban areas. (250 Words)
- 30 Social consciousness ruled by mob mentality results in institutionalizing violence through politics, caste and religion. Elaborate. (150 Words)

GS – II ... INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

- 1 How do you differentiate between transactional relations and transformational relations in the international diplomacy? Expand your answer with specific examples. Analyse whether India's relations with the neighbourhood are transactional or transformational.
(250 Words)
- 2 Examine how far the recent developments in West Asia's geopolitical landscape affect India. (150 Words)
- 3 After several years of convergence in interests, India-USA relations are facing several irritants now. Critically analyse the irritants faced in the diplomatic relations between India and USA. (150 Words)

GS – III ... ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

- 22 In recent times, Indian economy is facing the problem of Negative Output Gap. What do you understand by this? Examine the reasons and give valid suggestions to reduce the Negative Output Gap. (250 Words)
- 23 Examine how empowerment, equality of opportunity and preservation of natural capital can be integrated into the goal of achieving \$ 5 trillion economy by 2024-25. (250 Words)
- 24 Own Account Enterprises, which employ no hired workers on regular basis, is both boon and bane of Indian economy. Discuss. (150 Words)

GS – IV ...ETHICS & INTEGRITY

40 Explain the philosophy of Utilitarianism as propounded by Jeremy Bentham and JS Mill. (150 Words)

41 Discuss the ethical framework of 2nd ARC to enforce ethics in public life. (150 Words)

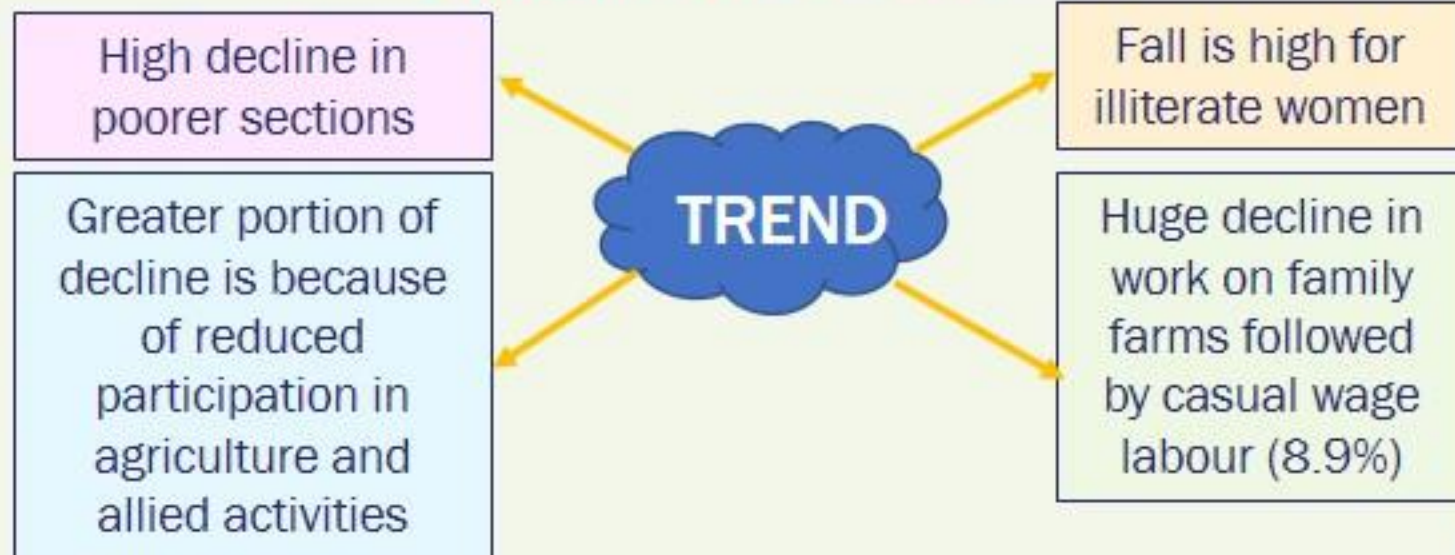
42 What are the steps to facilitate the engagement of civil society in governance as per 2nd ARC? (150 Words)

Worker to population ratio among women reduced drastically in rural areas in comparison to urban areas. Is it due to faster decline in work opportunities in rural India for women? Argue. How far do the present Government policies facilitate protecting the livelihoods of rural women? (250 Words)

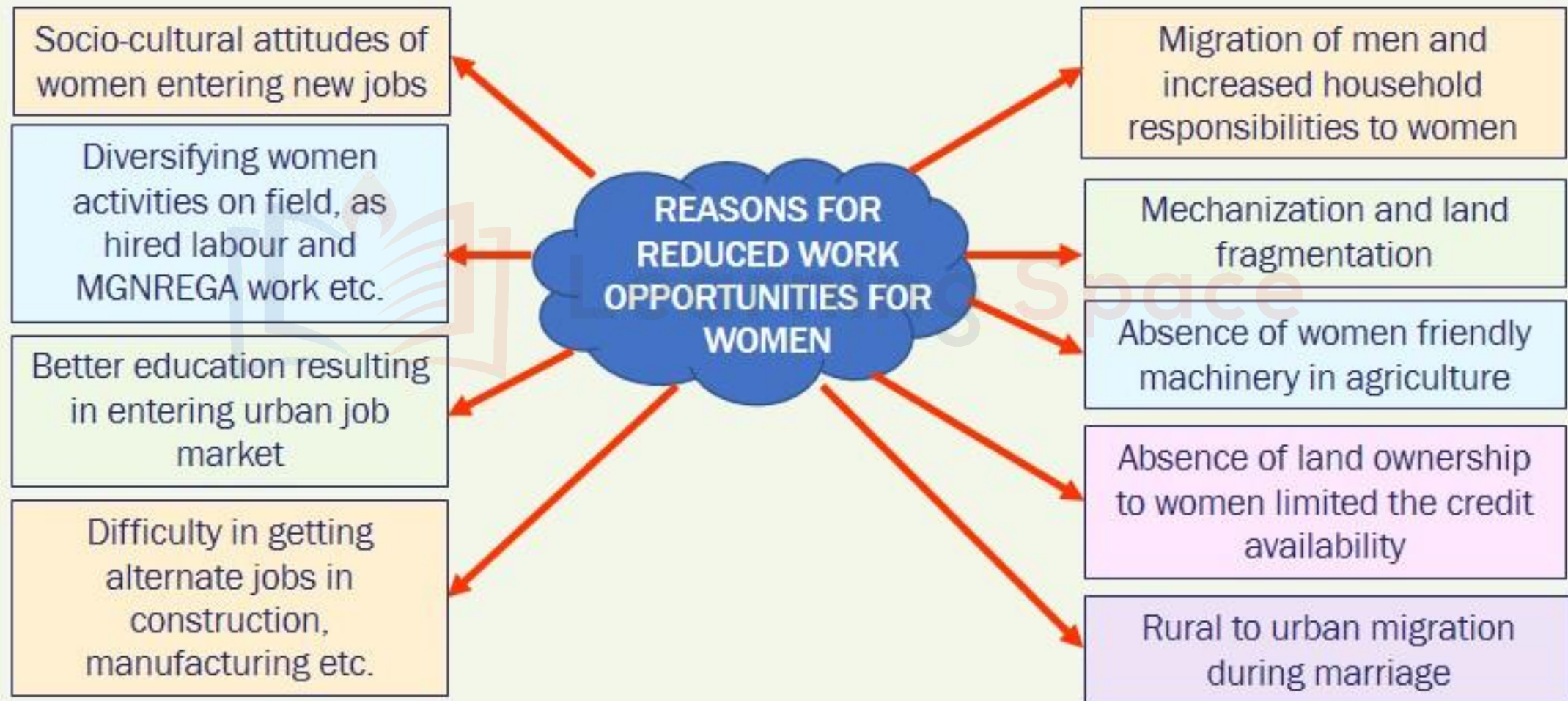
As per Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS), half the rural women who were in workforce in 2004-05 had dropped out in 2017-18. The drop in worker to population ratio (WPR) is rapid and significant in rural than in urban areas.

FACTS

- WPR for rural women aged 15 and above has dropped from 48.5% in 2005 to 35.2% in 2012 and then to 23.7% in 2018.
- WPR for urban women aged 15 and above declined from 22.7% in 2005 to 19.5% in 2012 to 18.2% in 2018.

TREND IN RURAL AREAS

REDUCED WORK OPPORTUNITIES – DECLINE IN WPR



PRESENT GOVERNMENT POLICIES

- **MGNREGA**
 - ✓ More than 55% of beneficiaries are women.
- **BETI PADA0 – BETI BACHAO**
 - ✓ Promotes girl child education and adequate healthcare for girls.
- **PM UJJWALA YOJANA**
 - ✓ Reduced women need to gather solid fuel by providing LPG.
- **STAND UP INDIA**
 - ✓ Focus on women entrepreneurs.
- **WOMANIYA ON GeM**
 - ✓ Mandating for government to buy at least 3% of goods or services from women entrepreneurs.

THE WAY AHEAD

Government should focus on rural outsourcing of back office jobs and provide adequate training to rural women as part of Skill India Mission. Providing safe transport to nearby towns and multi sectoral reforms that positively impact work opportunities are needed.

“More than a third of India’s population lives in urban areas and they produce more than 3/5th of the country’s GDP, but the governance structures in urban areas / semi-urban areas are archaic and chaotic”. Do you agree? Give valid arguments. Suggest the way forward for orderly growth of urban areas. (250 Words)

Strong urban local bodies is a need for bringing equality, liveability and democratic governance in the process of urban transformation. India witnessed unplanned urbanization resulting in overlap of governance structures, lack of transition from rural to urban areas. This made the urban governance archaic and chaotic on political, administrative and financial fronts.

1. POLITICAL

- Activism with regard to ward committees and metropolitan planning committees are enabled.
- But, they are captive to interests of certain elite resident welfare associations at times.

2. ADMINISTRATIVE

- Elected representatives at city level, say mayor, are powerless.
- Executive powers are vested with municipal commissioner appointed by the state government.
- Parastatal agencies are accountable only to the state government.
- Most important urban planning and land use regulation is with the state government controlled development authorities.
- Overlapping of powers resulted in urban governance being no one’s responsibility.
- State government delegating decision making powers to CEOs of special purpose vehicles disempowered elected local governments.



3. FINANCIAL

- Even for performing functions within local government's purview, such as levying local taxes or undertaking civil projects, it requires state government's permission.
- Even with permission, ULB's are inefficient in tax collections like property tax.
- ULBs frequently experience financial crisis.

THE WAY FORWARD FOR ORDERLY URBANISATION

- Local governments should have functional autonomy. A dedicated list of separation of subjects between state and ULB can be considered.
- They should have financial autonomy and should aim to be financially viable.
- Parastatals should not be allowed to undermine the authority of ULBs.
- Need to establish a dedicated and a specialized trained cadre to serve and cater to complex needs of urban local governance.
- Use of technology like satellite maps to trace tax evasion and increase tax collection efficiency.

Social consciousness ruled by mob mentality results in institutionalizing violence through politics, caste and religion. Elaborate. (150 Words)

Social consciousness regulates the attitudes and behaviour of individuals by social conditioning. Mob mentality ruling over social consciousness can be a means to identity-based fringe elements to justify violating law and order.



MOB MENTALITY – IDENTITY BASED VIOLENCE

- Religion as identity
 - ✓ Godhra riots
 - ✓ Muzaffarpur violence
 - ✓ Violent activities during partition
 - ✓ Lynching against cow slaughter
- Caste as identity
 - ✓ Destruction of public property during protests for reservation
 - ✓ Violation of women's modesty during caste conflicts
- Politics as identity
 - ✓ Faction wars driven by power politics
 - ✓ Other identities of caste and religion being flared up for political advantage

CONCLUSION

Strong anti-lynching laws as enacted by Manipur are needed to counter such mob mentality. Preventive measures with effective inter-agency coordination is more needed than reactive and adhoc measures.

1 / IR
GS - II

How do you differentiate between transactional relations and transformational relations in the international diplomacy? Expand your answer with specific examples. Analyse whether India's relations with the neighbourhood are transactional or transformational. (250 Words)

Transformational and transactional relations in international diplomacy are distinct in their focus and approach in meeting a nation's interests.

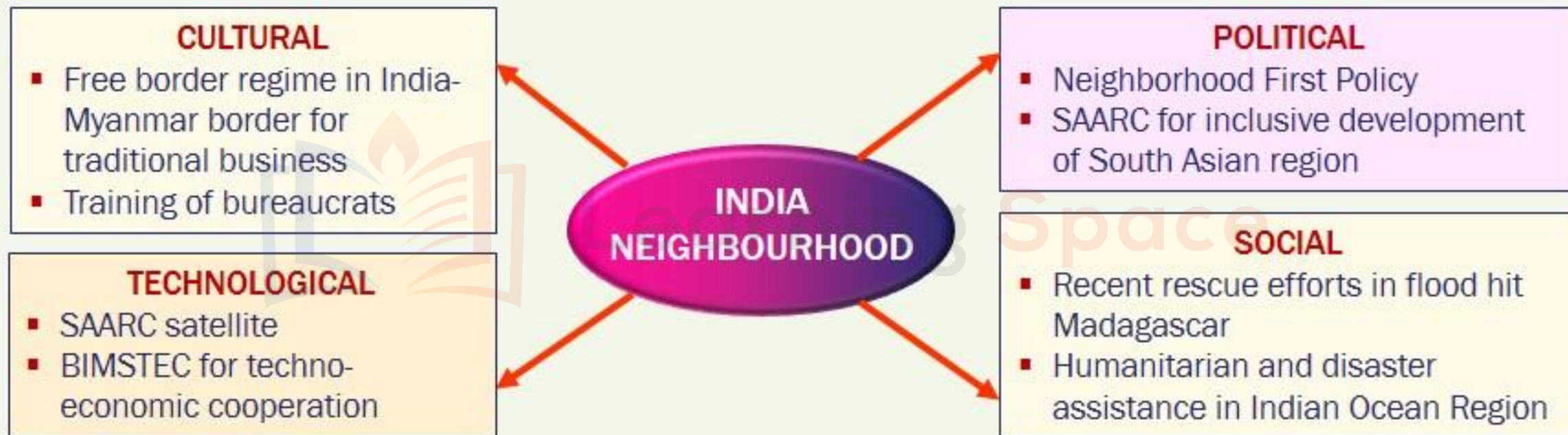
SUBJECT	TRANSACTIONAL	TRANSFORMATIONAL
FOCUS	Goals and self-interests of the nations	Vision and holistic development of all
APPROACH	Complete the project as agreed with other nation in exchange for a reward that meets nation's self-interests	Based on awareness and capacity to meet needs and aspirations of each other
POLICIES	Reactive in nature	Proactive in nature



SUBJECT	TRANSACTIONAL	TRANSFORMATIONAL
MOTIVATION	Use rewards and punishments	Use charisma, cultural connect and enthusiasm
DIPLOMACY	Part of hard diplomacy	Part of soft diplomacy
EXAMPLE	▪ America's Protectionism ▪ America First Policy in trade relations ▪ America's trade war with China ▪ China's OBOR project ✓ Opacity in lending process ✓ Profit and Commercial motive in foreign relations ▪ China's cheque book diplomacy	▪ India's relations with neighbors ▪ Construction of Parliament building and schools in Afghanistan ▪ Giving cows as part of 'Girinka' in Rwanda ▪ Construction of friendship bridge in Bangladesh

INDIA'S RELATIONS WITH NEIGHBOURHOOD

India is maintaining transformational relations with all her neighbors through socio-economic, technological, cultural and political relations.



FINALLY

In the increasingly unbalanced multipolar world, India needs to complement its transformational relations with strategic autonomy to protect sovereignty and transactional relations when needed.

Examine how far the recent developments in West Asia's geopolitical landscape affect India. (150 Words)

Since 1990-91 Gulf War, India adopted a balancing approach in the West Asian region. It allowed India to remain out of regional disputes and de-hyphenate relations with regional rivals including Iran, Israel and Saudi-Arabia. But the recent fast changing geopolitics is expected to affect India in multiple ways.

DEVELOPMENTS IN WEST ASIA – EFFECT ON INDIA

1. ISOLATION OF IRAN

- ✓ USA's sanction on Iran and CAATSA.
- ✓ Saudi Arabia and other Arab Gulf nations moving away from Iran to prevent rise of Iran.
- **EFFECT ON INDIA**
 - ✓ Increases vulnerability of energy security with reduced oil imports from India.
 - ✓ Commercial interest from Shaheed Beheshti port affected.
 - ✓ Gateway to Central Asia and INSTC is hampered.

2. ECONOMIC STABILITY OF SAUDI ARABIA IS A NEED FOR INDIA

- ✓ Investments by Saudi Aramco in India.
- ✓ Huge Indian diaspora in the Arab Gulf.

3. NORMALISATION OF RELATIONS BETWEEN ISRAEL AND GULF COUNTRIES

- ✓ India's defence imports and technological cooperation with Israel is secured.
- ✓ India's oil imports from Arab Gulf is secured.

4. NEW FRAMEWORK FOR PEACE BETWEEN ISRAEL AND PALESTINE

- ✓ India's emphasis on Palestine's peace may affect India-Israel relations.

5. INDIA'S SUPPORT FOR TRADE DEAL WITH IRAN AFFECTS INDIA-USA STRATEGIC RELATION

THE WAY AHEAD

India needs to devote more amount of diplomatic and political energies to deal with unfolding changes in West Asia. The constraints with Iran and economic stability in middle east along with Indian diaspora, technological superiority of Israel are making India's position highly complex in West Asia.

After several years of convergence in interests, India-USA relations are facing several irritants now. Critically analyze the irritants faced in the diplomatic relations between India and USA. (150 Words)

India-USA relations have advanced to strategic partnership over a decade and further moved ahead with agreements like LEMOA. But, various irritants in recent time have decelerated the pace.

IRRITANTS IN INDIA-US RELATIONS

IRRITANTS

FOR USA

- USA's perception of India not giving equitable and reasonable access to its market
 - ✓ **EXAMPLES:** High tariffs by India on Harley Davidson motorcycles
 - ✓ Tightening of e-commerce norms in marketplace model affects companies like Amazon, Walmart
 - ✓ Data localization norms affect Visa and Master card
 - ✓ Trade deficit with India
- Claims that India's subsidies are against WTO norms
- Questions India's status of developing country

FOR INDIA

CONTD...



IAS MAINS 2020 - VALUE ADDITION

IRRITANTS IN INDIA-US RELATIONS

IRRITANTS

FOR USA

FOR INDIA

- USA withdrawing generalized system of preferences
- End of waivers for Iran oil
- No clarity under CAATSA on S-400 purchase from Russia
- Afghan negotiations going on without Afghan government
- Limited market access for Indian services exporters
- Visa curbs for professionals
- Restrictions under H1B visas

CONCLUSION

India should give high priority to strategic autonomy and sovereignty. Apart from bilateral dialogue to unclog the irritants with USA, India should diversify its trade destinations, defence imports and achieve self-reliance on fronts of energy and technology.

In recent times, Indian economy is facing the problem of Negative Output Gap. What do you understand by this? Examine the reasons and give valid suggestions to reduce the Negative Output Gap. (250 Words)

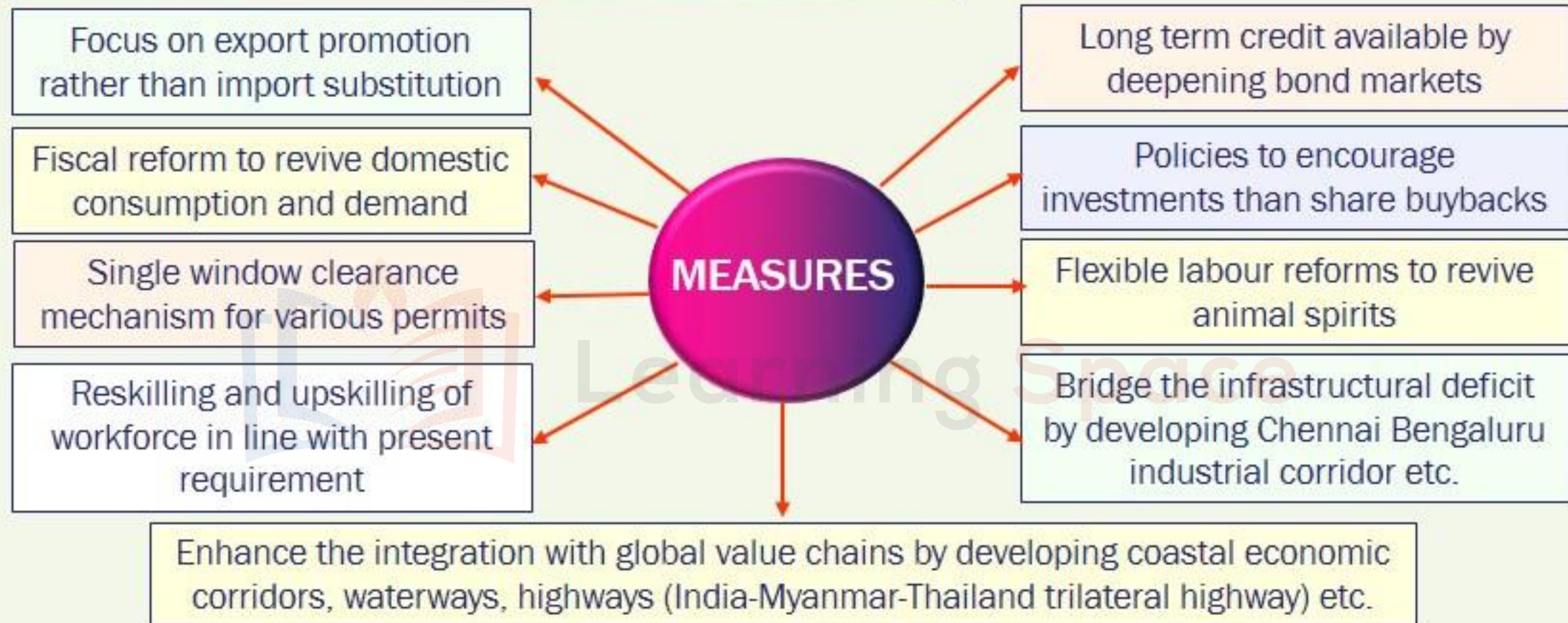
Negative output gap suggests that actual economic output is below the economy's full capacity for output.



REASONS FOR NEGATIVE OUTPUT GAP

- Twin balance sheet problems
- Slowdown of world economy
- Reduced domestic and global demand
- Absence of long-term credit because of immature bond markets
- Issues of land and environment clearances
- Inclined towards share buy backs rather than expanding investments
- Infrastructural bottle necks
- No integration with global value chains
- Multiple regulations still hamper the ease of doing business
- Rigid labour laws constrain moving funds from labour to investments
- Inability to withstand global competition
- Failure of import substitution policy
- Poorly skilled work force

MEASURES TO REDUCE NEGATIVE OUTPUT GAP



THE WAY AHEAD

Bridging the output gap will be an efficient means to reserve the economic slowdown. This should be supported by encouraging more MSMEs to create jobs and increase consumption. As stated by Economic Survey 2020, promoting private investments and export promotion policies is the key.

23 / ED
GS - III

Examine how empowerment, equality of opportunity and preservation of natural capital can be integrated into the goal of achieving \$ 5 trillion economy by 2024-25.
(250 Words)

The goal of achieving \$5 trillion economy by 2024-25 can be made inclusive and sustainable by integrating empowerment, equality of opportunity and preservation of natural capital. Such integration will make growth as a means to development than an end in itself.

\$ 5 TRILLION ECONOMY - INTEGRATION

1. EMPOWERMENT

ISSUES

- Broken education system
- Poor public health infrastructure
- Unskilled or semi-skilled workforce results in unemployment and underemployment
- Capability deprivation
- 140th rank in World Happiness Report

MEASURES

- New education policy in line with social and techno-economic advancements
- Increase investment on health to 2.5% of GDP
- Reskilling and upskilling under PM Kaushal Vikas Yojana
- Promoting and integration of startup India, make in India
- Ease of living as a basis for policy making (Budget 2020)

2. EQUALITY OF OPPORTUNITY**ISSUES**

- Rising income inequalities
- Perpetuating gender inequalities

MEASURES

- Equalizing capabilities across individuals by empowering them
- Ensuring access to public resources to backward sections
- Restructuring reservation policy to let the benefits reach the deserved sections

3. PRESERVING NATURAL CAPITAL**ISSUES**

- 2/3rds of world's most polluted cities are in India.
- Pollution hampering the productivity of people.
- Growth at the cost of people's lives is not suggested.

MEASURES

- Promoting E-vehicles by strict implementation of FAME
- Urban planning based on Green spaces
- Increasing renewable energy capacities
- Boost to green economy
- Adopting environment inclusive economic growth

WAY AHEAD

Any improvement in the life of majority would require a re-alignment of the growth process towards a less damaging, inclusive and sustainable ecosystem.

Own Account Enterprises, which employ no hired workers on regular basis, is both boon and bane of Indian economy. Discuss. (150 Words)

Own Account Enterprise (OAE) is any self-owned business or enterprise in which an individual works for him/herself with or without assistance of family members.

As per NSSO, OAEs or the Proprietary Enterprises accounted for 62% of the workforce and workers in the OAEs outnumbered those engaged by big enterprises in the country.

OAEs – BOON TO THE ECONOMY

- Women entrepreneurs are concentrated in these enterprises
- Acts as livelihood security for the children
- Meets the demands at hyperlocal level
- Acts as an additional source of income
- Creates self-employment in times of jobless growth
- Needs no integration of global value chains

OAEs – BANE TO THE ECONOMY

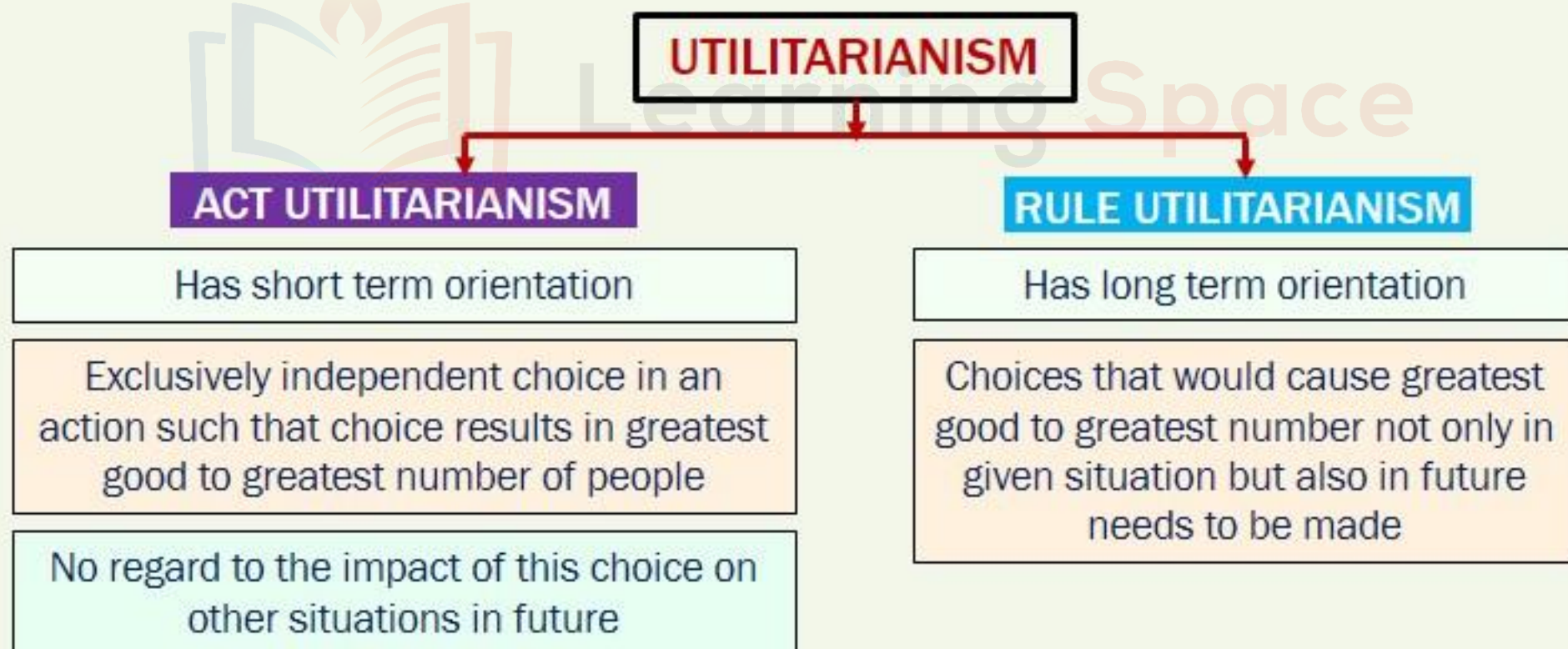
- Creates under employment and disguised unemployment
- Seasonal in nature and depends on availability of raw materials
- Perpetuates informalization of economy
- Doesn't contribute to global markets
- Women at disadvantageous position in access to basic infrastructure

WAY AHEAD

There is a need to upgrade these enterprises to greater scale by creating awareness and state support. Policies that assess entrepreneurship from a much broader and diverse framework is necessary.

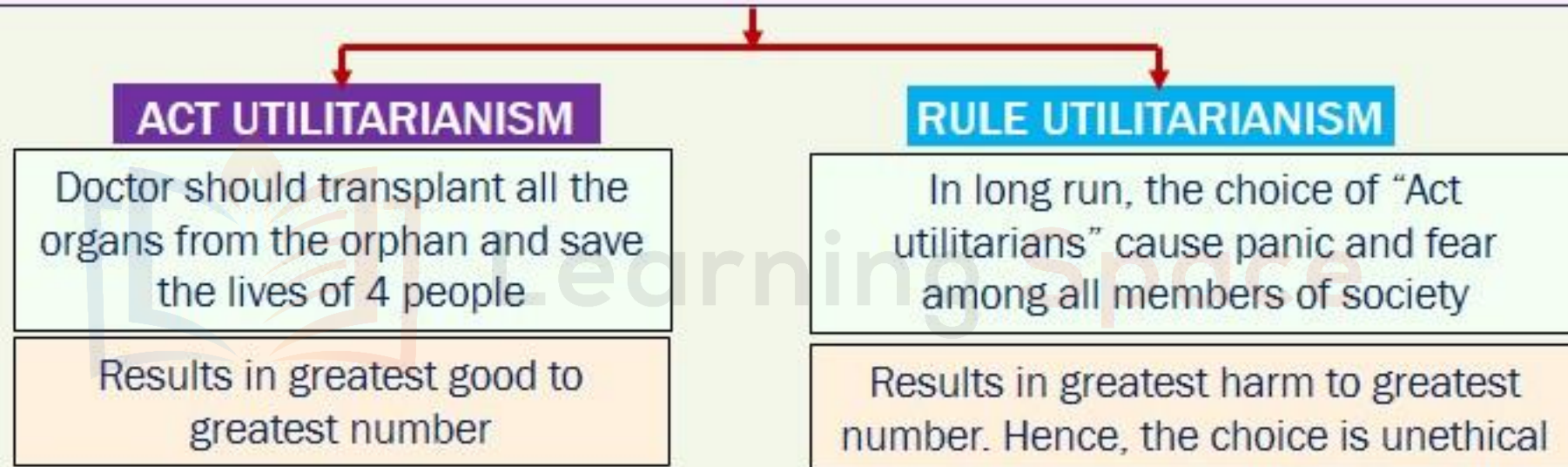
Explain the philosophy of Utilitarianism as propounded by Jeremy Bentham and JS Mill.
(150 Words)

- According to Utilitarian approach, the action that produces the greatest good to the greatest number of people for greatest amount of time is moral/ethical.
- Under this theory, Pain to a few individuals is justified if that pain causes greatest good to greatest number of people. The philosophy has two approaches.



1. EXAMPLE

- Suppose a doctor has 4 patients - one need a heart transplant, the other a kidney transplant, the other a lung transplant and last one needs liver transplant.
- Doctor is simultaneously treating another orphan patient, whose death would not be bereaved by anyone.



2. EXAMPLE

- Killing a terrorist is ethical since it saves lot of innocent people in the long run.

CONCLUSION

Utilitarian philosophy of ethical decision cannot be applied in a universal way. But, at times of crisis, utilitarianism guides in required decision making.

Discuss the ethical framework of 2nd ARC to enforce ethics in public life. (150 Words)

ETHICS IN PUBLIC LIFE

- All public functionaries are trustees of the people.
- The role of ethics in public life has many dimensions. At one end is the expression of high moral values and at the other, the specifics of action for which a public functionary can be held legally accountable.
- Any framework of ethical behavior must include the following elements:
 - ✓ Codifying ethical norms and practices
 - ✓ Disclosing personal interest to avoid conflict between public interest and personal gains
 - ✓ Creating a mechanism for enforcing the relevant codes
 - ✓ Providing norms for qualifying and disqualifying a public functionary from officeEg: Seven Principles of Nolan Committee.



- Seven principles of public life laid down by Nolan Committee
 - ✓ Selflessness: Holders of public office should take decisions solely in public interest
 - ✓ Integrity: Holders of public office should not place themselves under obligation to outsiders that could influence them in their duties
 - ✓ Objectivity: Choices be made on merit
 - ✓ Accountability: Be accountable to one's decisions and actions
 - ✓ Openness: Be as open as possible in all decisions and actions
 - ✓ Honesty: Take steps to resolve conflicts such that public interest is promoted
 - ✓ Leadership: Promote the above principles by example.

CONCLUSION

Ethics in public life will not only act as role model and source of virtue ethics for other people but also ensures harmony in one's private life.

What are the steps to facilitate the engagement of civil society in governance as per 2nd ARC? (150 Words)

Civil society plays a major role in success of any government initiative by engendering participatory governance. It acts as citizens' voice in dealing with public policy.

- Steps to facilitate the engagement of civil society in governance
 - ✓ Inviting civil society to oversee government programs
 - ✓ Establishing and disseminating service standards
 - ✓ Establishing credible complaints mechanisms
 - ✓ Enforcing access to information
 - ✓ Using public hearing to audit government activities
 - ✓ Holding integrity workshops and public hearings at local levels
 - ✓ Incorporating corruption as a subject in education curriculum
 - ✓ Setting up websites on containing corruption, facilitating dialogue and feedback from citizens
- Government should use positive inducements or rewards for civil society to disclose information on corruption.

RECOMMENDATIONS

- Remedy for sub-standard service levels should be specified in Citizens' Charter itself
- Reward schemes should be introduced to incentivize citizens initiatives
- School awareness programs should be introduced, highlighting the importance of ethics and how corruption can be combated.

THE WAY AHEAD

It is the government's imperative to implement the 2nd ARC recommendations not only in letter but also in spirit to deepen inclusive democracy.



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SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

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